index, are more useful determinants of plant distribution than simple temperature and rainfall figures.

"… the time is not far distant when all species of plants and their geographical distribution will be well known."

Andreas Schimper



Like other epiphytes, Spanish moss lives on other species but draws water and nutrients from the air rather than from its host. It thrives in tropical and subtropical environments.

See also: Evolution by natural selection • Ecophysiology • The ecosystem • The foundations of plant ecology • Biogeography • Biomes